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Computing device upgrading system over a wireless network

Abstract

Disclosed herein are system, method, and computer program product embodiments for a computing device upgrading system over a wireless network. An embodiment operates by determining that a computing device is connected to an upgrader device over a wireless network connection. It is determined that an upgrader mode of the computing device is activated based on the determination that the wireless network connection to the upgrader device is active. A command is received at the computing device. It is determined that a speed of the wireless network connection exceeds a threshold. The command is transmitted to the upgrader device based on both the determination that the upgrader mode of the computing device is active and the determination that the speed of the wireless network connection exceeds the threshold. At the computing device, a response from the upgrader device executing the command is received, and content is output.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/137,479 titled “Computing Device Upgrading System Over A Wireless Network”, filed Apr. 21, 2023, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/699,733 titled “Media Device Upgrading System Over A Wireless Network”, filed Mar. 21, 2022, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/700,600 titled “Network-Based Media Device Upgrading System”, filed Dec. 2, 2019, which is a continuation-in-part of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/357,740 titled “Media Device Upgrading System”, filed Mar. 19, 2019 which claims priority to U.S. Provisional Appl. No. 62/646,994 titled “Media Device Upgrading System,” filed Mar. 23, 2018, and further claims priority to U.S. Provisional Appl. No. 62/900,919 titled “Network-Based Media Device Upgrading System,” filed Sep. 16, 2019, all of which are herein incorporated by reference in their entireties.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) This disclosure generally relates to the upgrading of media devices.

BACKGROUND

(2) Smart televisions allow a user to access different applications that provide on-demand access to different types of content from different content providers. While these apps are often upgraded and changed, particularly to take advantage of new and ever advancing technologies, the hardware in old (previously purchased) televisions remains the same. With this divergence, it does not take much time for old TVs to lose the ability to effectively support and run new apps.

SUMMARY

(3) Various embodiments are described throughout this specification. This disclosure is not limited to the summary provided herein.

(4) An example embodiment may include a computer-implemented method. In an embodiment, it is

determined that a computing device is configured to output content received by the computing device over a wireless network. It is determined that the computing device is connected to an upgrader device over the wireless network connection. It is determined that an upgrader mode of the computing device is activated based on the determination that the wireless network connection to the upgrader device is active. A command is received at the computing device. It is determined that a speed of the wireless network connection exceeds a threshold. The command is transmitted to the upgrader device based on both the determination that the upgrader mode of the computing device is active and the determination that the speed of the wireless network connection exceeds the threshold. At the computing device, a response from the upgrader device executing the command is received, and content is output.

(5) Another embodiment may include a computing device including at least processor configured to perform various operations. In an embodiment, it is determined that the computing device is configured to output content received by the computing device over a wireless network. It is determined that the computing device is connected to an upgrader device over the wireless network connection. It is determined that an upgrader mode of the computing device is activated based on the determination that the wireless network connection to the upgrader device is active. A command is received at the computing device. It is determined that a speed of the wireless network connection exceeds a threshold. The command is transmitted to the upgrader device based on both the determination that the upgrader mode of the computing device is active and the determination that the speed of the wireless network connection exceeds the threshold. At the computing device, a response from the upgrader device executing the command is received, and content is output.

(6) Another embodiment may include a non-transitory computer-readable device having instructions stored thereon. In an embodiment, it is determined that a computing device is configured to output content received by the computing device over a wireless network. It is determined that the computing device is connected to an upgrader device over the wireless network connection. It is determined that an upgrader mode of the computing device is activated based on the determination that the wireless network connection to the upgrader device is active. A command is received at the computing device. It is determined that a speed of the wireless network connection exceeds a threshold. The command is transmitted to the upgrader device based on both the determination that the upgrader mode of the computing device is active and the determination that the speed of the wireless network connection exceeds the threshold. At the computing device, a response from the upgrader device executing the command is received, and content is output.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) The accompanying drawings are incorporated herein and form a part of the specification.
- (2) FIG. 1A is a block diagram illustrating a databus-based media device upgrading system, according to some embodiments.
- (3) FIGS. 1B-1D illustrate example embodiments of the system providing for databus-based media device upgrading, according to some example embodiments.
- (4) FIG. 2 is a flowchart illustrating example operations of a network-based media device upgrading system, according to some embodiments.
- (5) FIG. 3 is a flowchart illustrating example operations of a USB-based media device upgrading system, according to some embodiments.
- (6) FIG. 4 is an example computer system useful for implementing various embodiments.
- (7) In the drawings, like reference numbers generally indicate identical or similar elements.

Additionally, generally, the left-most digit(s) of a reference number identifies the drawing in which the reference number first appears.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(8) Provided herein are system, apparatus, device, method and/or computer program product embodiments, and/or combinations and sub-combinations thereof, for a databus-based media device upgrading system.

(9) FIG. 1A is a block diagram **100** illustrating a databus-based media device upgrading system, according to some embodiments. The system of FIG. 1A may be used to improve the processing speed and capabilities of a media device **102** (such as a television). For example, when a user buys a new television, the user may be able to operate all of the latest apps and games and receive high quality and fast access to the various functionalities of these apps (such as but not limited to streaming media applications).

(10) However, as technology improves, these apps and new apps may be adapted and updated to take advantage of this improving technology. As such, at a certain point, the original hardware of the television may no longer be suitable for executing these new and adapted apps configured to take advantage of the capabilities of the newer equipment (e.g., the original television hardware may be too slow or incapable of executing all the functions these apps). As such, a user is often forced to buy a new television for a satisfactory or improved viewing experience. The system described herein may enable the television (e.g., media device **102**) to be upgraded without having to trash and replace the old television and may effectively extend the useful life of media devices **102**.

(11) Media device **102** may be any device capable of receiving and outputting media in visual, audio, and/or other multimedia format. Example media devices include televisions (including smart televisions), streaming media players, laptops, desktops, mobile phones, radios, monitors, soundbars, voice responsive devices (such as voice responsive speakers, personal digital assistants, etc.), wearable computing devices, appliances, internet of things (IoT) devices, and/or other computing devices.

(12) For purposes of illustration, and not limitation, media device **102** may sometimes be referred to herein as a television (which may include a smart television capable of receiving streaming or other network-based or cloud-based content), but it is understood that in other embodiments, other types of media devices may be used, including a streaming device connected to a television, monitor, gaming or media streaming console, and may include audio-only devices.

(13) Media device **102** may include an app **106A** that has been installed. Through app **106A**, media device **102** may be capable of receiving and outputting streamed and/or packaged media in audio, video, and/or other multimedia formats. For example, app **106A** may enable a user **103** to select and watch television shows, movies, or music videos on media device **102**. Examples of commercially available apps **106A** include but not are limited to NETFLIX, HULU, SLING, HBO GO, and YOUTUBE. In other embodiments, app **106A** may include network-based and/or interactive video games which may be single-player or multi-player. Other examples of app **106A** will be apparent to persons skilled in the relevant art(s). During the execution of app **106A**, media device **102** may connect to a content provider **124** to receive one or more image files **126** which are received and output.

(14) As noted above, while the primary example used throughout will be in terms of a television (media device **102**) and a video streaming application (app **106**), however it is understood that the processes described herein may be applied to other embodiments as well. For example, media device **102** may include another app, streaming, or gaming console such as APPLE TV, AMAZON ECHO, GOOGLE HOME, XBOX, NINTENDO SWITCH, PLAYSTATION, smartphone, appliance, Internet of Things (IoT) device, etc. And the app **102** may include audio, multimedia, or gaming applications, to name just some examples.

(15) Content provider **124** may include one or more content servers that store and make available

data (e.g., image files **126**) to be output or displayed on media device **102** through app **106A**. For example, when user **103** selects a movie to watch, app **106A** may direct media device **102** to connect to one or more content servers (e.g., content provider **124**) to retrieve image files **126** (which may include streaming media such as movies and/or still images such as logos, movie posters, text, audio files, etc.), gaming scenarios, etc. which are received and displayed or otherwise output on media device **102** through app **106A**.

(16) Media device **102** may be configured with firmware **108** and a device operating system which is configured to execute various applications, games, programs, or apps **106A** and output media using the hardware components of media device **102**. The various hardware components of media device may include one or more processors, memory (e.g., such as random access memory, buffers, cache, etc.), audio and video decoders, wireless communication modules (Wi-Fi, Bluetooth, infrared, motion detection, etc.), speakers, and resolution modules, and/or other components. Such hardware components are generally collectively indicated as hardware, and may include a display **140**.

(17) Generally speaking, at the time of manufacture, the hardware included in a given television or other media device **102** may be state-of-the-art and capable of supporting the newest apps **106**. But, as technologies change and advance, the processing capabilities of new televisions and other devices similarly change and advance. Seeking to optimize the user experience, app developers may upgrade or change the operations and/or requirements of apps **106** to take advantage of new hardware and computer processing technologies. But, the hardware of previously manufactured televisions or gaming consoles remains the same. Over time, the changes to apps **106** that take advantage of new technology may cause a degradation of the user experience in older televisions (e.g., due to slow processor speeds, limited memory, and/or other inability to support the latest apps **106**).

(18) Eventually, some of the apps **106** may no longer be functional in older televisions, or the user experience may be degraded to such a point that a user or customer may be forced to take action to replace or upgrade the media device **102**. Conventionally, the only possible actionable solutions were (1) for the user to refurbish his older TV with new hardware and software, a process that was time consuming, expensive, and technically challenging process; or (2) for the user to purchase a new television or media device altogether, which was often even more expensive than refurbishing.

(19) However, rather than resorting to either of these unenviable, expensive, and environmentally wasteful options, the upgrader embodiments described herein may be used to upgrade a user experience with an existing older television or other devices by offloading some of the processing tasks required by applications, programs, games, or apps **106A** to another host device **110**.

(20) Host device **110** may provide access to new hardware functionality capable of supporting the changes in apps **106** that are intended to take advantage of hardware capabilities beyond the hardware capabilities which were originally provided in media device **102**. For example, host device **110** may provide more, enhanced, or faster processors, memory, etc. In a coordinated manner, host device **110** may extend the useful lifespan of media device **102** by supporting at least a partial execution of existing, new and upgraded apps **106** through dividing the labor of executing app **106** and leveraging the state-of-the-art or more available hardware capabilities of host device **110** working in combination with the original hardware capabilities of media device **102**.

(21) In various embodiments, host device **110** may be communicatively coupled to media device **102** over a databus **120**. Databus **120** may include one or more communication channels that provide for bidirectional synchronous or asynchronous communication between host device **110** and media device **102**. Example databuses **120**, as will be described in greater detail below, include the Internet, a private network (such as home, local, or corporate network), and a universal serial bus (USB) or other physical connection.

(22) FIG. 1B illustrates an example embodiment in which databus **120** is the Internet **120A**, and host device **110** may include network or cloud servers **110A** that communicate with media device

102 using the internet protocol (IP) or other Internet-compatible communication protocols. In an embodiment, the upgrader system as provided by cloud servers **110A** may include free, paid, or subscription services.

(23) FIG. **1C** illustrates an example embodiment in which databus **120** may be a local network **120B** and host device **110** may include a network device **110B** that is configured to connect to and communicate with media device **102** over the home or private network **120B**. Example network devices **110B** include a range extender or other standalone upgrader or device that communicates with media device **102** over a corporate, home, private, or local network **120B** to which both devices **102**, **110B** are connected. In another embodiment, network device **110B** may communicate with media device **102** over Bluetooth, infrared, or other communication channels which may operate as the databus **120**.

(24) FIG. **1D** illustrates an example embodiment in which databus **120** may be a hardwired or physical connection, such as a universal serial bus (USB) available through a port **120C**. Host device **110** may be a USB device **110C** such as a thumb drive or media or streaming stick, or other device that is configured to be coupled with or connected into a USB, HDMI (high definition multimedia interface), or other port **120C** of media device **102**. In an embodiment, removing networking features from network device **110B**. may make it possible for a smaller and/or less expensive USB device **110C**.

(25) Returning to FIG. **1A**, the cloud service embodiment of host device **110** communicating with media device **102** over the Internet (e.g., operating as a databus **120**) will be used as the primary context herein. However, it is understood that many of the features applicable to the cloud service host device **110** are also applicable to the network device and USB device embodiments. Any distinctions particular to the various embodiments are described herein.

(26) In an embodiment, media device **102** may include different modes of operation **109**. In a first mode of operation **109**, referred to as a “normal mode,” media device **102** may operate without using or interacting with host device **110**. In a second mode of operation **109**, referred to as an “upgrader mode,” media device **102** may operate in coordination with host device **110** as described herein over one or more databuses **120**.

(27) During the normal mode of operation, media device **102** may be disconnected from host device **110** or databus **120** may be unavailable. During normal mode of operation, app **106A** may be executed using the installed or original hardware of media device **102**, and commands **118** may be received and processed locally by firmware **108** and transferred directly to app **106A**.

(28) When in upgrader mode, host device **110** may provide for a seamless integration with media device **102** over databus **120**. In this upgrader mode, the “look and feel” of the user experience may remain relatively or exactly the same, except that processing time may be improved and delays may be reduced in the execution of app **106A** and the output of media through media device **102**. Accordingly, from an end user **103** point-of-view, the functionality of media device **102** may appear to be the same, even while the responsiveness and capabilities may be improved through leveraging the more powerful and expanded hardware capabilities of the host device **110** through databus **120**.

(29) In an embodiment, host device **110** and media device **102** may respond to user commands **118** received using a remote control **112** associated with media device **102**. For example, the remote control **112** may be the same original remote control that came with television or media device **102** (which may be connected to a television) when it was manufactured. Remote control **112** may be used to both control the operation of the television hardware (such as power, volume, display settings, input selection, etc.) and the device OS functionality (such as menu selections, downloading and launching applications **106**, operating the apps **106**, etc.). In other embodiments, remote control **112** may be joystick, controller, laptop, voice-activated microphone, or mobile phone that has been communicatively coupled with media device **102**.

(30) In an embodiment, firmware **108** may receive commands **118** from remote control **112**, and

determine whether to direct command **118** to the hardware of media device **102**, app **106A**, host device **110**, or content provider **124**.

(31) During upgrader mode, a portion of operations of app **106** are performed by remotely executing versions of app **106A** on one more host devices **110**. These operations may include application-related or input commands **118** received from remote control **112**. In an embodiment, firmware **108** may check to determine whether databus **120** and host device **110** are available to determine whether or not to operate in upgrader mode. This mode check may occur when media device **102** is powered on or booted up, upon the activation or instantiation of a local execution of app **106A**, periodically, or upon receiving one or more commands **118** from remote control **112**.

(32) In an embodiment, firmware **108** may periodically check the connection status with host device **110**, and if the connection is lost or regained, firmware **108** may toggle back and forth between normal mode and upgrader mode seamlessly (e.g., without notifying the user interrupting a user's experience). In another embodiment, firmware **108** may check the speed or available bandwidth of databus **120** and if it falls below a threshold, firmware **108** may enter media device **102** into normal mode. In an embodiment, a visual or audio notification of the mode of operation **109** may be provided to the user, even as the connection to host device **110** may be gained and/or lost.

(33) Unlike some prior approaches, the user **103** is not required to manage two devices independently, and may not even be aware of which mode of operation **109** is being executed on media device **102** in the execution of one or more apps **106**. Host device **110** operates seamlessly with the media device **102** using a single remote control **112** and the media device **102**'s original user interface, to provide a seamless upgrade to various aspects of the media device **102** which enables the two devices to act as one unified device. User **103** may continue operating the same media device **102** with the same remote control **112** regardless of the mode of operation **109**.

(34) In an embodiment, when a command **118** is received from remote control **112**, firmware **108** may determine whether the command **118** is one to be handled by the media device **102**'s original hardware, app **106A**, or whether to provide or transmit command **118** to host device **110** to be handled by the host device **110**'s hardware and processing capabilities based on the mode of operation **109**.

(35) In an embodiment, there may be a set of commands **118** particular to the operation of media device **102** that are always handled locally by the local or original hardware of media device **102** independent of the mode of operation **109**. These commands **118** may include, hardware command such as power on/off commands, volume adjustment commands, visual adjustment commands (e.g., brightness, tint, color, hue, etc.).

(36) Other application commands or app or software directed commands, such as selections to launch app **106A**, exit app **106A**, select or browse movies and other multimedia to consume, adjust settings, logging in, navigation, switching users, moving a player, fast-forward, rewind, etc. may be handled by firmware **108** and may be directed to app **106A** and/or host device **110** for processing in upgrader mode.

(37) As illustrated in FIG. 1A, host device **110** may be executing app **106B**. App **106B** may be a new instance or mirror of the same version of app **106A** executing on media device **102**. In an embodiment, app **106B** may be configured to be a mirror or clone executing the operations of the application **106** responsive to user commands **118** received from remote control **112** locally on host device **110**.

(38) For example, when an application command **118** is detected at media device **102**. Firmware **108** may transmit the command **118** to host device **110** over databus **120**. Host device **110** may provide the command **118** to app **106B**. Host device **110** may then intercept, capture, or record the response of app **106B** and provide the response (e.g., render **130**, fetch **132**, or draw **134**) to media device **102** which is then executed.

(39) In an embodiment, the command **118** may be a launch command **118** in which user **103** selects

app **106** from an interface of media device **102**. Upon receiving launch command **118**, firmware **108** may simultaneously activate or launch app **106A** locally on media device **102** and provide or make available the launch command **118** and/or user data **122** to host device **110** over databus **120**. In an embodiment, launch command may be processed locally on media device **102**.

(40) User data **122** may include any locally stored information (on media device **102**) about one or more user accounts associated with app **106A**. In an embodiment, user data **122** may include usernames, passwords, version numbers, age, restrictions, color schemes, preferred settings, usage and login history, an identification of which user **103** is logged into or using media device **102**, or other user information. In an embodiment, user data **122** may be provided to host device **110** over databus **120** in addition to or in lieu of a launch command **118**, and may be interpreted as signaling a launch command **118**.

(41) Upon receiving launch command **118**, host device **110** may identify and instantiate a new instance of the same app **106** as app **106B** with same version number and login or user information, usage history, and other data as indicated by user data **122**. As referenced above, host device **110** may include a cloud networking system (**110A**) with multiple servers which may be configured to simultaneously execute different versions of app **106A** across one or more different media devices **102** and/or user accounts that are geographically distributed.

(42) For example, host device **110** may be executing both version 1 of app **106** for a first user operating a first television, and version 2 of app **106** (or another instantiation of version 1) for a second user operating a second television. In an embodiment, upon a successful launch and configuration of app **106B** on host device **110**, host device **110** may communicate an acknowledgement or successful connection signal which may cause firmware **108** to enter upgrader mode. In an embodiment, the acknowledgement signal an IP address of the host device which is handling commands **118**. Host device **110** may provide a render command **130** indicate what media or images are to be output by media device **102**.

(43) In the absence of an acknowledgement signal, or upon the receipt of a failure signal, firmware may periodically send one or more launch commands **118** until an ack signal is received or a time or retry threshold is reached and the host device **110** is deemed unavailable. Until a successful connection acknowledgement is received or connection is confirmed with host device **110**, media device **102** may continue operating in normal operational mode.

(44) In an embodiment, if upgrader mode has already been entered for one app **106** on media device **106**, then upgrader mode may continue for a second app **106** which is activated on media device **102**. In an embodiment, the second app may not be available or supported in upgrader mode (e.g., by a host device **110**) and media device **102** may have one app **106** executing in upgrader mode, and a second unsupported app executing in normal mode. In an embodiment, a first host device **110** may be providing upgrader functionality for a first app **106A** on media device **102**, while a second host device **110** is providing upgrader functionality for a second app **106A** on media device **102** over the same or different databuses **120**.

(45) In an embodiment, upon a successful configuration and launch of app **106B**, app **106B** may issue one or more render commands **130**. Render command **130** may be any command issued by an app **106** that indicates what is to be executed, retrieved, rendered, or otherwise output by media device **102** on an interface **136** of a display **140** for app **106**.

(46) For example, render command **130** may indicate which images, text, video, audio, etc. are to be output and/or the orientation of any of these features. In an embodiment, render command **130** may include a location or screen area on interface **136** where to render the command on media device **102**.

(47) In an embodiment, user data **122** may include an indication as to on which media device **102** app **106A** is executing (e.g., type of device, model number, manufacturer, year of manufacture or release, firmware version, operating system version, processing capacity, memory, etc.). For example, the dimensions of a display **140** may impact which render commands **130** are provided

responsive to commands **118** by app **106B**. These render commands **130** may be received over databus **120** and executed by media device **102** to draw or display interface **136** of app **106A**. (48) In an embodiment, the render command **130** may include fetch commands **132** and draw commands **134**. Fetch commands **132** may indicate which file or media is to be retrieved from content provider **124** or a local memory for rendering an interface **136** of app **106A**. Rather than executing a fetch command **132** locally on host device **110** and then transferring the fetched file to media device **102** over databus **120** (which would consume additional processing resources, memory and bandwidth), host device **110** may simply transmit fetch command **132** to media device **102**.

(49) Media device **102** may then execute the fetch command **132** to retrieve the file into local storage or memory. Executing the fetch command **132** may include contacting one or more servers across one or more different content providers **124** to retrieve audio and/or image files **126** (which may include static image or sound files, or streamed media).

(50) Or, for example, fetch command **132** may indicate a locally stored file on media device **102** to be fetched, retrieved, or otherwise used. For example, when app **106A** is installed or instantiated on media device **102**, app **106A** may store a set of files that are commonly used locally in the memory of whatever device **102** on which app **106A** has been installed or is executing. Fetch **132** may refer to fetching one or more of these locally stored or accessible files. Fetch **132** may include a network or local address or description of which file is to be retrieved or fetched.

(51) Upon detecting that the identified file(s) have been fetched, retrieved, or otherwise made available (e.g. in the random access or disk-based memory of media device **102**), firmware **108** may transmit an acknowledgement message to host device **110** (indicating that the files were or were not successfully retrieved or fetched). This acknowledgement message may include metadata corresponding to the fetched file. The metadata may include a file name, size, location, file type, etc. The acknowledgement (and metadata) message may be transferred to host device **110** over one or more channels of databus **120**.

(52) In an embodiment, if host device **110** does not receive a fetch acknowledgment message within a threshold period of time, the same render **130**, fetch **132**, or draw **134** command may be re-sent or re-transmit over databus **120** until a threshold number of times has been reached or an acknowledge is received.

(53) If a threshold number of transmits or time threshold has been reached and no acknowledgement has been received, in an embodiment, host device **110** may interpret this as a media device **102** crash and quit or exit app **106B** or move app **106B** to a background process to save or free up local host **110** resources. These host resources may then be made available to other processes, including supporting other media devices (in a cloud computing or network computing embodiment). For example, host device **110** if communicating over the same local network (e.g., databus **120**) as media device **102**, may support the processing of multiple locally connected televisions, gaming consoles, media devices **102**.

(54) In an embodiment, render commands **134** may include draw commands **134**. Draw commands **134** may indicate where particular lines, shapes, text, and in which colors are to be displayed on interface **136**. In an embodiment, a render command **130** may include draw commands **134**, fetch commands **132**, and/or other processing or output commands. In an embodiment, a render command **130** may include the coordinates and/or relative locations of the various objects to be displayed on interface **136**.

(55) Firmware **108** may receive the render commands **130**, including fetch commands **132** and/or draw commands **134**, and execute the render commands locally at media device **102** and generate or draw interface **136** on display **140** of media device **102**. Upon successful execution, media device **102** may transmit an acknowledgment message to host device **110**. In other embodiments, the acknowledgment may not be transmit. This process of generating and capturing or intercepting the render commands **130** on host device **110** and then transferring the render commands **130** over

databus **120** to media device **102** may result in significant processing and resource utilization savings for media device **102**, including faster rendering, fewer delays and an improved user experience.

(56) For example, media device **102** (when in upgrader mode) may no longer use its own resources to generate its own render **130**, fetch **132**, and/or draw **134** commands using local processing capabilities of media device **102** (which may be slower than using host device **110** hardware and receiving the render commands **130** over databus **120**).

(57) Instead, host device **110** uses its improved or more available processing resources to mirror or clone version of app **106B** similar to app **106A** as it is being executed locally on media device **102**, to generate commands render **130**, fetch **132**, and draw **134**. Then, for example, media device **102** may simply execute the received commands (e.g., similar to a monitor). This upgrader mode may effectively extend the useful life of media device **102**, save consumers or user **103** money, and prevent landfills from being filled up with discarded media devices **102**.

(58) In an embodiment, in upgrader mode, firmware **108** may provide commands **118** to both app **106A** and host device **110** (to be executed by app **106B**). Then, for example, firmware **108** may execute the first response received from either host device **110** (from app **106B**) or app **106A**. Any duplicate or later command may then be discarded or ignored. In this manner, app **106A** and app **106B** may be coordinated, such that if there is an issue with databus **120** or other connection to host device **110**, the user experience may continue without being interrupted.

(59) As noted above, FIGS. **1B-1D** illustrate three example embodiments of the system described above with respect to FIG. **1A**, according to some example embodiments. FIG. **1B** illustrates a cloud-configured service embodiment, in which host device **110** is one or more servers **110A** (that may or may not be arranged into a cloud configuration) with which media device **102** communicates over the Internet **120A**. Internet **120A** may be used as the one or more communication channels of databus **120**.

(60) In the cloud-based embodiment, an upgrader service provider may identify a subset of media devices using a particular operating system that are accessing or that have downloaded a particular app **106**. The app **106** may be particular targeted for upgrading (e.g., because it relies on technological advancements beyond what is capable on media device **102**). In this manner, cloud servers **110A** may be configured to provide upgrader services for some apps **106** and/or devices **102**, and not others.

(61) In an embodiment, an upgrader service provider may identify a particular manufacturer name, model number, and/or manufacturing year of media device **102** for which to provide upgrader services. For example, SAMSUNG televisions, model 5, with a ROKU operating system may be selected for upgrade. It may be determined that the hardware of is model of television or device is no longer compatible or with takes too long (e.g., beyond a threshold) to perform one or more functions of app **106**.

(62) In another embodiment, cloud server **110A** may be available to a wide range of different devices, or any device with a particular operating system or a particular app **106**. In an embodiment, cloud server **110A** may identify the hardware associated with a particular media device **102**, and may perform a subset of functions known to be slow processing or which the original or identified hardware of a particular media device **102** may not be able to handle. For example, a newer media device **102** may be able to process its own draw commands **134**, but fetch commands **312** may be still be received from a cloud server **110A**, while an older media device **102** may be upgraded by receiving both draw and fetch commands **132**, **134** from cloud server **110A**. Over time, as apps **106A** and technology changes, the same device **102** may have more processing offloaded or performed by cloud server **110A**. Additionally, new devices **102** and/or apps **106** may be added and supported by the cloud servers (as host **110**).

(63) One or more cloud servers **110A** may be configured as host devices **110** for identified media devices **102** meeting the specified qualifications. In an embodiment, these identified televisions

(e.g., media devices **102**) may be provided a firmware **108** upgrade. For example, based on their opting into or paid subscription for upgrader services, user **103** may be requested to authorize a firmware upgrade to enable different modes of operation **109**, including a new upgrader mode. (64) The firmware upgrade may cause firmware **108**, instead of processing all commands **118** locally at media device **102**, to begin transferring a subset of commands **118** to host device **110** when in upgrader mode, as described herein. This firmware-based upgrade may enable the upgrader mode to be applied to legacy media devices **102** that were already manufactured and in operational use prior to the development or availability of an upgrader mode or an upgrader service, including the services and devices described in FIGS. **1C** and **1D** below. Further, this firmware upgrade may be applied to legacy applications **106** without requiring a developer of the applications to change how the applications receive or process commands **118**, or stream media (e.g., image file **126**).

(65) In another embodiment, the mode of operation **109** functionality may already be present within firmware **108** or an operating system of media device **102**. In another embodiment, the upgrade may be integrated within app **106A** rather than firmware **108**.

(66) FIG. **1C** illustrates a network device embodiment, in which host device **110** is a local network-configured device **110B** with which media device **102** communicates over the local network **120B**. While local network **120B** may be used as the one or more communication channels of databus **120**, network device **110B** and/or media device **102** may still access the Internet **140** (and content providers **124**) through local network **120B** or separate cellular or network connections.

(67) Local network **120B** may be a university, corporate, home, or other private or public network which supports multiple devices to connect and communicate with one another and/or access the Internet **140**. In an embodiment, network device **110B** may include its own Wi-Fi or other networking capabilities to request or receive streaming content or apps **106** from an app store or content provider **124**, and communicate with media device **102**.

(68) In an embodiment, a user **103** may plug in and configure host device **110** (as a local network device) to communicate with media device **102** over the same local, private, or public network. In an embodiment, network device **110B** may broadcast or advertise its capabilities (e.g., for upgrading) to one or more devices over a wireless network (e.g., using the network device **110B**'s Wi-Fi or networking capabilities). For example, network device **110B** may use simple service discovery protocol (SSDP) which may enable discovery and communication between network device **110B** and media device **102**.

(69) In an embodiment, while using a network device **110B** may require a user **103** to configure a new device **110B** onto their local network **120B**, the network device **110B** may also potentially reduce a latency between media device **102** and host device **110** relative to a cloud or other Internet-communications based host device **110A**. For example, wireless communications between devices may be faster between the devices are located same room or operating on the same network relative to two devices that are located hundreds or thousands miles apart (which may be the case in a cloud services embodiment). Also, communications over local network **120B** may not be subject to outages and network delays in the same way that Internet **120A** communications may be.

(70) As referenced above, FIG. **1D** illustrates an embodiment, in which host device **110** is embodied in a USB device **110C** with which media device **102** communicates over an input port **120C**. In an embodiment, input port **120C** may be a USB port on media device **102**, and USB device **110C** may be stick or other small plugin device that connects directly to media device **102** and communicates over the databus **120** of USB.

(71) In an embodiment, a user may insert upgrader device **110** into a particular one of the ports **120**, such as port **120C** for example purposes (which may be an HDMI port, for example), and then send a command **118** to switch the input of media device **102** to port **120C**, to thereby enable the plug-and-play capabilities and interactions between upgrader device **110** and media device **102**.

(72) Media device **102** may have Internet access **140** through cellular or local network connections.

In an embodiment, USB device **110C** may leverage some of the original hardware of media device **102** to provide a user with the perception and “look and feel” as if the app **106A** is operating fully on media device **102** and to save network bandwidth and other processing resources.

(73) In another embodiment, USB device **110C** may utilize or leverage the Wi-Fi or networking capabilities in the original hardware of media device **102** to download apps **106**, which may then be displayed through media device **102** as described herein. USB device **110C** may also derive its power through the capabilities of USB.

(74) In an embodiment, to operate with the media device **102**, USB device **110C** may first need to be recognized by media device **102**. For example, USB device **110C** may be physically inserted into one of the ports **120C**. Port **120C** may include a high-definition multimedia interface (HDMI) port, universal serial bus (USB) port, and/or any other port used by computing devices.

(75) In another embodiment, handshaking and/or discovery between upgrader device **110** and media device **102** may be performed after or upon insertion of upgrader device **110** into port **120C**. In an embodiment, USB device **110C** may not have networking or Wi-Fi capabilities, and may instead communicate with media device **102** via a USB port (rather than using an HDMI port). Through the USB port, USB device **110C** may be able to receive power from media device **102** and/or have access to the networking capabilities of media device **102** (through which USB device **110B** can request or control what content or apps **106** are downloaded or streamed to the media device **102**).

(76) Returning to FIG. **1A**, in an embodiment, upon an initial synchronization between media device **102** and host device **110** (**110A**, **110B**, and/or **110C**), user **103** may be visually prompted to confirm that the user wants to enter upgrader mode **109** and perform the synchronization or handshaking process between host device **110** and media device **102**. For example, the user may be asked if they want to upgrade media device **102** using an upgrader or host device **110**. If the user says ‘no’, then firmware **108** may continue normal operations. However, if the user says ‘yes’, then the synchronization process may continue to enable a seamless connection and operation of the host device **110** with the media device **102**.

(77) During synchronization or as a result thereof, bi-directional communication between host device **110** and media device **102** may be enabled. During the synchronization process, host device **110** may obtain information regarding the media device **102** in order to at least emulate and interact with the media device **102**. Thus, for example, the host device **110** may read or import configuration information, account information for a cloud account and/or for accessing content providers (such as HBO, NETFLIX, HULU, etc.), settings, preferences, history, graphical assets (so as to match, operate with, augment, enhance, emulate, etc., the TV **102**’s UI), WiFi credentials, and other user information from media device **102**, which may be stored as user data **122**.

(78) For example, if media device **102** is a television, host device **110** may copy or import an electronic program guide, port names, account information for apps **106**, preferences, viewing history, and other information which may have been stored and/or used by device **102**. In an embodiment, this user data **122** information may be accessible via a flash or other memory of media device **102** (assuming the media device **102** previously exported and/or saved the information to such flash or other memory), and may be accessed and retrieved using NFS (network file system) or some other well-known protocol. In some embodiments, the flash or other memory may be secured so access is limited to the host device **110** and/or other authorized devices. Then, for example, during upgrader mode **109**, host device **110** may use the television **102** as a monitor and speaker system for playing back content, while the media device **102** itself provides the media streaming functionality.

(79) From an end-user point-of-view, the operations and functionality of media device **102** may appear the same, regardless of whether a command **118** is being handled or processed by media device **102** (normal mode) versus host device **110** and then media device **102** (upgrader mode). For example, the menu and other UI interactions may appear the same regardless of which mode of

operation **109** is active. In another embodiment, media device **102** may include a visual or other indicator that differentiates between normal mode and upgrader mode. For example, the color of a menu may change, or the display may indicate that upgrader mode is active.

(80) The processing by firmware **108** may be the same amongst the various embodiments of host device **110** and databus **120** (e.g., cloud server-internet, local device-local network, or plugin device-USB) to how commands **118** are handled. Commands **118** may include hardware commands and/or operational or software commands. In some embodiments, hardware commands are those that involve device-specific interactions with hardware features of the media device **102**, such as a request to adjust the input or output settings of media device **102**. Regardless of the mode of operation **109**, hardware commands may be handled locally by firmware **108** without a message being sent to host device **110**.

(81) Other example hardware commands may include requests to adjust the volume, adjust display settings (e.g., tint, hue, brightness, color), adjust audio controls (e.g., bass, treble, balance), and switch active input ports. For example, a command **118** to make the active input port so that a user may play a video game on game console (or watch a DVD) may be handled by firmware **108** and/or media device **102** without any message sent to host device **110**.

(82) In some embodiments, operational or software commands may include requests to browse, purchase, download, launch, or otherwise interact with content or apps **106**. For example, a user may want to download a new application **106**, download content from content provider **124**, or pause or rewind content via an active application **106**, to name just some examples. In an embodiment, during normal mode, these commands may be handled or processed by media device **102**, while during upgrader mode these commands may be handled or processed by host device **110** (for app **106B**) in addition to media device **102** (app **106A**).

(83) In an embodiment, when a user issues a command **118**, the user may be unaware of whether the command **118** is being handled by firmware **108**, media device **102**, host device **110**, or some combination of devices. For example, the commands accessible via remote control **112**, as well as operation of the remote control **112**, may remain the same during both normal mode and upgrader mode **109**. In an embodiment, remote control **112** may include soft or programmable keys, and may include new or additional functionality that may be available only during upgrader mode **109** when commands **118**. For example, app **106** may include features that are only accessible using the new or upgraded hardware of host device **110**.

(84) FIG. 2 a flowchart **200** illustrating example operations of a network-based media device upgrading system, according to some embodiments. Method **200** can be performed by processing logic that can comprise hardware (e.g., circuitry, dedicated logic, programmable logic, microcode, etc.), software (e.g., instructions executing on a processing device), or a combination thereof. It is to be appreciated that not all steps may be needed to perform the disclosure provided herein. Further, some of the steps may be performed simultaneously, or in a different order than shown in FIG. 2, as will be understood by a person of ordinary skill in the art. Method **200** shall be described with reference to FIG. 1A. However, method **200** is not limited to that example embodiment.

(85) In **210**, a fetch command is received from a first instance of an application executing locally on a host device. For example, media device **102** may be operating in an upgrader mode (**109**). Firmware **108** may receive a command **118** from remote control **112** as being operated by a user **103**. Command **118** may be provided to app **106A** and host device **110A** for processing. Host device **110** may provide command **118** to app **106B** for processing. App **106B** may process command **118** using the hardware of host device **110** and may generate a render command **130**, which may include a fetch **132** and/or draw command **134**. Host device **110** may receive the fetch **132** command from app **106B**.

(86) In **220**, the fetch command is provided to a media device executing a second instance of the application to fetch the file associated with displaying an interface of the application on the media device. For example, fetch **132** received by host device **110** may indicate a network address of an

image file **126** to be retrieved for display in interface **136**. Host device **110** may provide this fetch **132** command to media device **102** which may then fetch the image file **126**. In another embodiment, the fetched file may be stored locally on media device **102**.

(87) In **230**, metadata corresponding to the file that was retrieved by the media device responsive to an execution of the fetch command by the media device is received at a host device. For example, the metadata of the file may include the file name, the location, size, type and/or an acknowledgment message that the file was retrieved. Firmware **108** may provide this metadata to app **106A** and/or host device **110**. Host device **110** may receive this metadata about image file **126**.

(88) In **240**, a rendering command is determined from the first instance of the application corresponding to displaying the interface including the fetched file as indicated by the metadata. For example, the metadata may be provided to app **106B** which may generate a draw **134** command or render **130** command that indicates where to place or how to draw the interface **136** of app **106** using the fetched image file **126**. The render **130** command may include coordinates, dimensions, shapes, colors, and other visual attributes necessary to render interface **136** on display **140** of media device **102**.

(89) In **250**, the rendering command is provided to the media device. For example, host device **110** may transfer the render **130** command to media device **102**. Media device **102** may then execute the render command **130** and the fetched file **126** (which may be stored in a local memory of media device **102**) to display interface **136** on a screen or display of media device **102**.

(90) FIG. 3 a flowchart **300** illustrating example operations of a USB-based media device upgrading system, according to some embodiments. Method **300** can be performed by processing logic that can comprise hardware (e.g., circuitry, dedicated logic, programmable logic, microcode, etc.), software (e.g., instructions executing on a processing device), or a combination thereof. It is to be appreciated that not all steps may be needed to perform the disclosure provided herein. Further, some of the steps may be performed simultaneously, or in a different order than shown in FIG. 3, as will be understood by a person of ordinary skill in the art. Method **300** shall be described with reference to FIGS. 1A and 1D. However, method **300** is not limited to that example embodiment.

(91) In **310**, a fetch command is received from a first instance of an application executing locally on a host device physically connected to media device, wherein the fetch command indicates a file to be retrieved from a network-accessible computing device. For example, as illustrated in FIG. 1D, USB device **110C** may be connected to an input port **120C** of media device **102**. And USB device **110C** may have an app **106B** operating locally from which a fetch **132** command is received (e.g., responsive to a command **118**) received from media device **102**.

(92) In **320**, the fetch command is provided to the media device executing a second instance of the application to fetch the file associated with displaying an interface of the application on the media device. For example, the fetch **132** command is provided from USB device **110C** to media device **102**, which executes the fetch command **132**. Execution of the fetch **132** command may include retrieving streaming media or an image file **126** from content providers **124** or another network or Internet-accessible location.

(93) In **330**, metadata corresponding to the file that was retrieved by the media device responsive to an execution of the fetch command by the media device is received at the host device. For example, upon receiving the stream of media or image file **126**, media device **102** may read and provide metadata from image file **126** to host device **110** (e.g., USB device **110C**).

(94) In **340**, a rendering command corresponding to the interface, wherein the rendering command includes a draw command received from the first instance of the application and the metadata. For example, USB device **110C** may capture or receive a render **130** command on how to draw **134** interface **136** in display **140** of media device, using or positioning the retrieved or fetched file **126** or stream of media.

(95) In **350**, the rendering command is provided to the media device, wherein the media device is

configured to display the interface of the application responsive to executing the rendering command, and wherein the interface includes the fetched file. For example, USB device **110C** may provide render **130** to media device **102** over the USB port **120C**, and media device **102** may render interface **136** responsive to command **118**.

(96) Various embodiments may be implemented, for example, using one or more well-known computer systems, such as computer system **400** shown in FIG. **4**. One or more computer systems **400** may be used, for example, to implement any of the embodiments discussed herein, as well as combinations and sub-combinations thereof.

(97) Computer system **400** may include one or more processors (also called central processing units, or CPUs), such as a processor **404**. Processor **404** may be connected to a communication infrastructure or bus **406**.

(98) Computer system **400** may also include user input/output device(s) **403**, such as monitors, keyboards, pointing devices, etc., which may communicate with communication infrastructure **406** through user input/output interface(s) **402**.

(99) One or more of processors **404** may be a graphics processing unit (GPU). In an embodiment, a GPU may be a processor that is a specialized electronic circuit designed to process mathematically intensive applications. The GPU may have a parallel structure that is efficient for parallel processing of large blocks of data, such as mathematically intensive data common to computer graphics applications, images, videos, etc.

(100) Computer system **400** may also include a main or primary memory **408**, such as random access memory (RAM). Main memory **408** may include one or more levels of cache. Main memory **408** may have stored therein control logic (i.e., computer software) and/or data.

(101) Computer system **400** may also include one or more secondary storage devices or memory **410**. Secondary memory **410** may include, for example, a hard disk drive **412** and/or a removable storage device or drive **414**. Removable storage drive **414** may be a floppy disk drive, a magnetic tape drive, a compact disk drive, an optical storage device, tape backup device, and/or any other storage device/drive.

(102) Removable storage drive **414** may interact with a removable storage unit **418**. Removable storage unit **418** may include a computer usable or readable storage device having stored thereon computer software (control logic) and/or data. Removable storage unit **418** may be a floppy disk, magnetic tape, compact disk, DVD, optical storage disk, and/or any other computer data storage device. Removable storage drive **414** may read from and/or write to removable storage unit **418**.

(103) Secondary memory **410** may include other means, devices, components, instrumentalities or other approaches for allowing computer programs and/or other instructions and/or data to be accessed by computer system **400**. Such means, devices, components, instrumentalities or other approaches may include, for example, a removable storage unit **422** and an interface **420**. Examples of the removable storage unit **422** and the interface **420** may include a program cartridge and cartridge interface (such as that found in video game devices), a removable memory chip (such as an EPROM or PROM) and associated socket, a memory stick and USB port, a memory card and associated memory card slot, and/or any other removable storage unit and associated interface.

(104) Computer system **400** may further include a communication or network interface **424**. Communication interface **424** may enable computer system **400** to communicate and interact with any combination of external devices, external networks, external entities, etc. (individually and collectively referenced by reference number **428**). For example, communication interface **424** may allow computer system **400** to communicate with external or remote devices **428** over communications path **426**, which may be wired and/or wireless (or a combination thereof), and which may include any combination of LANs, WANs, the Internet, etc. Control logic and/or data may be transmitted to and from computer system **400** via communication path **426**.

(105) Computer system **400** may also be any of a personal digital assistant (PDA), desktop workstation, laptop or notebook computer, netbook, tablet, smart phone, smart watch or other

wearable, appliance, part of the Internet-of-Things, and/or embedded system, to name a few non-limiting examples, or any combination thereof.

(106) Computer system **400** may be a client or server, accessing or hosting any applications and/or data through any delivery paradigm, including but not limited to remote or distributed cloud computing solutions; local or on-premises software (“on-premise” cloud-based solutions); “as a service” models (e.g., content as a service (CaaS), digital content as a service (DCaaS), software as a service (SaaS), managed software as a service (MSaaS), platform as a service (PaaS), desktop as a service (DaaS), framework as a service (FaaS), backend as a service (BaaS), mobile backend as a service (MBaaS), infrastructure as a service (IaaS), etc.); and/or a hybrid model including any combination of the foregoing examples or other services or delivery paradigms.

(107) Any applicable data structures, file formats, and schemas in computer system **400** may be derived from standards including but not limited to JavaScript Object Notation (JSON), Extensible Markup Language (XML), Yet Another Markup Language (YAML), Extensible Hypertext Markup Language (XHTML), Wireless Markup Language (WML), MessagePack, XML User Interface Language (XUL), or any other functionally similar representations alone or in combination. Alternatively, proprietary data structures, formats or schemas may be used, either exclusively or in combination with known or open standards.

(108) In some embodiments, a tangible, non-transitory apparatus or article of manufacture comprising a tangible, non-transitory computer useable or readable medium having control logic (software) stored thereon may also be referred to herein as a computer program product or program storage device. This includes, but is not limited to, computer system **400**, main memory **408**, secondary memory **410**, and removable storage units **418** and **422**, as well as tangible articles of manufacture embodying any combination of the foregoing. Such control logic, when executed by one or more data processing devices (such as computer system **400**), may cause such data processing devices to operate as described herein.

(109) Based on the teachings contained in this disclosure, it will be apparent to persons skilled in the relevant art(s) how to make and use embodiments of this disclosure using data processing devices, computer systems and/or computer architectures other than that shown in FIG. **4**. In particular, embodiments can operate with software, hardware, and/or operating system implementations other than those described herein.

(110) It is to be appreciated that the Detailed Description section, and not any other section, is intended to be used to interpret the claims. Other sections can set forth one or more but not all exemplary embodiments as contemplated by the inventor(s), and thus, are not intended to limit this disclosure or the appended claims in any way.

(111) While this disclosure describes exemplary embodiments for exemplary fields and applications, it should be understood that the disclosure is not limited thereto. Other embodiments and modifications thereto are possible, and are within the scope and spirit of this disclosure. For example, and without limiting the generality of this paragraph, embodiments are not limited to the software, hardware, firmware, and/or entities illustrated in the figures and/or described herein. Further, embodiments (whether or not explicitly described herein) have significant utility to fields and applications beyond the examples described herein.

(112) Embodiments have been described herein with the aid of functional building blocks illustrating the implementation of specified functions and relationships thereof. The boundaries of these functional building blocks have been arbitrarily defined herein for the convenience of the description. Alternate boundaries can be defined as long as the specified functions and relationships (or equivalents thereof) are appropriately performed. Also, alternative embodiments can perform functional blocks, steps, operations, methods, etc. using orderings different than those described herein.

(113) References herein to “one embodiment,” “an embodiment,” “an example embodiment,” or similar phrases, indicate that the embodiment described can include a particular feature, structure,

or characteristic, but every embodiment can not necessarily include the particular feature, structure, or characteristic. Moreover, such phrases are not necessarily referring to the same embodiment. Further, when a particular feature, structure, or characteristic is described in connection with an embodiment, it would be within the knowledge of persons skilled in the relevant art(s) to incorporate such feature, structure, or characteristic into other embodiments whether or not explicitly mentioned or described herein. Additionally, some embodiments can be described using the expression “coupled” and “connected” along with their derivatives. These terms are not necessarily intended as synonyms for each other. For example, some embodiments can be described using the terms “connected” and/or “coupled” to indicate that two or more elements are in direct physical or electrical contact with each other. The term “coupled,” however, can also mean that two or more elements are not in direct contact with each other, but yet still co-operate or interact with each other.

(114) The breadth and scope of this disclosure should not be limited by any of the above-described exemplary embodiments, but should be defined only in accordance with the following claims and their equivalents.

Claims

1. A computer-implemented method, comprising: determining, by at least one computer processor, that a computing device is connected to an upgrader device over a wireless network connection, wherein the upgrader device includes hardware capabilities for processing content beyond capabilities of the computing device, and wherein during an upgrader mode of the computing device, at least a portion of a functionality of the computing device is executed by the upgrader device; receiving a command at the computing device; determining that a speed of the wireless network connection exceeds a threshold; transmitting the command to the upgrader device based on both the determination that the upgrader mode is active and the determination that the speed of the wireless network connection exceeds the threshold; receiving, at the computing device, a response from the upgrader device executing the command; and executing the received response at the computing device, wherein the received response directs the computing device to output at least a portion of the content.
2. The computer-implemented method of claim 1, wherein the content comprises streaming video game content.
3. The computer-implemented method of claim 1, wherein the content comprises only audio content.
4. The computer-implemented method of claim 1, wherein the upgrader device includes additional or faster memory relative to the computing device.
5. The computer-implemented method of claim 1, further comprising: evaluating the command to determine whether to execute the command locally at the computing device or to provide the command for execution at the upgrader device.
6. The computer-implemented method of claim 1, further comprising: receiving a second command; determining that the speed of the wireless network connection is less than the threshold; and executing the second command at the computing device based on the determination that the speed of the wireless network connection is less than the threshold.
7. The computer-implemented method of claim 6, further comprising: providing a visual notification that the computing device is operating in a normal mode of operation based on the determination that the speed of the wireless network connection is less than the threshold.
8. A system, comprising: one or more memories; at least one processor each coupled to at least one of the memories and configured to perform operations comprising: determining that the system is connected to an upgrader device over a wireless network connection, wherein the upgrader device includes hardware capabilities for processing content beyond capabilities of the system, and

wherein during an upgrader mode of the system, at least a portion of a functionality of the system is executed by the upgrader device; receiving a command at the system; determining that a speed of the wireless network connection exceeds a threshold; transmitting the command to the upgrader device based on both the determination that the upgrader mode is active and the determination that the speed of the wireless network connection exceeds the threshold; receiving, at the system, a response from the upgrader device executing the command; and executing the received response at the system, wherein the received response directs the system to output at least a portion of the content.

9. The system of claim 8, wherein the content comprises streaming video game content.

10. The system of claim 8, wherein the content comprises only audio content.

11. The system of claim 8, wherein the upgrader device includes additional or faster memory relative to the system.

12. The system of claim 8, the operations further comprising: evaluating the command to determine whether to execute the command locally at the system or to provide the command for execution at the upgrader device.

13. The system of claim 8, the operations further comprising: receiving a second command; determining that the speed of the wireless network connection is less than the threshold; and executing the second command at the system based on the determination that the speed of the wireless network connection is less than the threshold.

14. The system of claim 13, the operations further comprising: providing a visual notification that the system is operating in a normal mode of operation based on the determination that the speed of the wireless network connection is less than the threshold.

15. A non-transitory computer-readable medium having instructions stored thereon that, when executed by at least one computing device, cause the at least one computing device to perform operations comprising: determining that the at least one computing device is connected to an upgrader device over a wireless network connection, wherein the upgrader device includes hardware capabilities for processing content beyond capabilities of the at least one computing device, and wherein during an upgrader mode of the at least one computing device, at least a portion of a functionality of the at least one computing device is executed by the upgrader device; receiving a command at the at least one computing device; determining that a speed of the wireless network connection exceeds a threshold; transmitting the command to the upgrader device based on both the determination that the upgrader mode is active and the determination that the speed of the wireless network connection exceeds the threshold; receiving, at the at least one computing device, a response from the upgrader device executing the command; and executing the received response at the at least one computing device, wherein the received response directs the at least one computing device to output at least a portion of the content.

16. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 15, wherein the content comprises streaming video game content.

17. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 15, wherein the content comprises only audio content.

18. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 15, wherein the upgrader device includes additional or faster memory relative to the at least one computing device.

19. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 15, the operations further comprising: evaluating the command to determine whether to execute the command locally at the at least one computing device or to provide the command for execution at the upgrader device.

20. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 15, the operations further comprising: receiving a second command; determining that the speed of the wireless network connection is less than the threshold; and executing the second command at the at least one computing device based on the determination that the speed of the wireless network connection is less than the threshold.
